

Ch 2: Nationalism in India

**Complete Question Bank | 2M + 3M + 5M |
PYQ-Based (2020–2024)**

SECTION A — 2 MARKS (30 Questions)

Q1. What is meant by 'Begar'? Why did peasants resent it?

Q2. What was the Rowlatt Act of 1919? Why was it called a 'Black Act'? (PYQ 2022)

Q3. Who wrote 'Vande Mataram'? In which novel did it appear? (PYQ 2020)

Q4. What was the Jallianwala Bagh massacre? When and where did it occur?

Q5. Why did Mahatma Gandhi withdraw the Non-Cooperation Movement in February 1922? (PYQ 2021–22)

Q6. How was the Simon Commission greeted in India? Why were Indians opposed to it? (PYQ 2021–22)

Q7. Mention any two causes that led to the Civil Disobedience Movement. (PYQ 2021–22)

Q8. What was the Khilafat issue? Who led the Khilafat Movement in India?

Q9. What is meant by 'Satyagraha'? What was the principle behind it?

Q10. What event happened on 31 January 1930? Why was it significant? (PYQ 2020)

Q11. What was the Chauri Chaura incident? What was its impact on the national movement?

Q12. Who was Alluri Sitarama Raju? What movement did he lead? (PYQ SQP 2020–21)

Q13. Why was the Salt March of 1930 chosen as a symbol of resistance against colonialism?

Q14. What is meant by 'Swaraj'? How did different groups interpret it differently?

Q15. Who was Baba Ramchandra? What role did he play in the Awadh peasant movement?

Q16. Name any two items boycotted during the Civil Disobedience Movement. Why were they boycotted?

Q17. What were the main features of the Poona Pact of 1932?

Q18. Arrange in chronological order: (PYQ 2020) (i) Jallianwala Bagh Massacre (ii) Salt March (iii) Non-Cooperation Movement (iv) Rowlatt Act

Q19. What was the image of 'Bharat Mata'? Who first painted it and what did it symbolise?

Q20. Why did the Congress session at Lahore in 1929 become significant in India's freedom struggle?

Q21. What was the Gandhi-Irwin Pact of 1931? Name any two of its terms.

Q22. What is meant by 'Plantation workers' demand for Swaraj'? How did they interpret it?

Q23. Who was Dr. B.R. Ambedkar? What was his demand regarding Dalits in the national movement?

Q24. What was the significance of the tricolour 'Swaraj flag' designed during the nationalist movement?

Q25. What was the role of Abanindranath Tagore in building nationalist sentiment through art?

Q26. What is meant by 'Inland Emigration Act of 1859'? How did it affect plantation workers?

Q27. Name the book written by Mahatma Gandhi. What nationalist idea did it express?

Q28. Why did the Justice Party in Madras not boycott the council elections during the Non-Cooperation Movement?

Q29. What were 'Hartals'? Give one example of their use in the nationalist movement.

Q30. What was the Second Round Table Conference? Why did it fail?



SECTION B — 3 MARKS (45 Questions)

Q1. Explain the implications of the First World War on the economic and political situation of India. (PYQ 2023, 2020)

Q2. How did the Non-Cooperation Movement unfold in the cities and towns of India? (PYQ SQP 2021–22)

Q3. Analyse the ways through which people of different communities developed a sense of collective belonging in India. (PYQ 2023)

Q4. Examine the progress of the Civil Disobedience Movement among different strata of society. (PYQ 2023)

Q5. Why did Mahatma Gandhi start the Non-Cooperation Movement? Explain any three reasons. (PYQ SQP 2020–21)

Q6. Describe the role of Alluri Sitarama Raju in Andhra Pradesh during the 1920s. (PYQ SQP 2020–21)

Q7. Explain the role of poor peasants in the Civil Disobedience Movement. (PYQ 2020)

Q8. How did the First World War create a new economic situation in India? Explain three effects. (PYQ 2021–22)

Q9. Why did various classes and groups join the Civil Disobedience Movement? Explain with reference to any three groups.

Q10. How did rich peasants and women take part in the Civil Disobedience Movement?

Q11. Explain the role of the Khilafat Movement in uniting Hindus and Muslims during the Non-Cooperation Movement.

Q12. Describe how tribal peasants interpreted Gandhiji's message of Swaraj and participated differently in the Non-Cooperation Movement. (PYQ 2021–22)

Q13. What were the effects of the worldwide economic depression on India towards the late 1920s?

Q14. How did the Congress seek to develop the Non-Cooperation Movement? Explain any three stages proposed by Gandhiji.

Q15. Why were political leaders divided over the question of separate electorates? Explain the different views.

Q16. Explain three ways in which the ideas of nationalism developed through cultural processes in India.

Q17. What were the main features and outcomes of the Gandhi-Irwin Pact of 1931?

Q18. Why did the Non-Cooperation Movement begin to slow down in cities? Explain any three reasons.

Q19. How did different social groups participate in the Non-Cooperation Movement? Choose any three groups and explain.

Q20. Explain the significance of the Dandi March. How did it mark the beginning of the Civil Disobedience Movement?

Q21. How did Gandhiji use folk songs, imagery, and symbols to create a sense of national identity among Indians?

Q22. Explain the circumstances that led to the launch of the Non-Cooperation Movement in 1920.

Q23. What was the role of women in the Civil Disobedience Movement? Were they given equal political rights?

Q24. Why did Congress not initially include Dalits in the Civil Disobedience Movement? How did the Poona Pact resolve this?

Q25. How did the image of Bharat Mata help build nationalist sentiment? Compare briefly with Germania from Chapter 1.

Q26. Explain any three causes of the Jallianwala Bagh massacre and its immediate impact on the nationalist movement.

Q27. How did the merchants and industrialists support the Civil Disobedience Movement? What were their economic interests?

Q28. Describe the role of Baba Ramchandra in the Awadh peasant movement. How was it connected to the Non-Cooperation Movement?

Q29. What were the events that led Gandhiji to give an ultimatum to Lord Irwin on 31 January 1930?

Q30. How did the Inland Emigration Act affect plantation workers? Explain their participation in the nationalist movement.

Q31. What was the significance of the Lahore Session of Congress in December 1929? What resolution was passed?

Q32. Explain the role of Rabindranath Tagore in building a sense of Indian nationalism through culture.

Q33. How did the Indian National Congress evolve from an elite organisation into a mass movement under Gandhiji's leadership?

Q34. Why was the Rowlatt Act seen as an attack on civil liberties? What was Gandhiji's response to it?

Q35. Describe the major limitations of the Civil Disobedience Movement. Why did certain groups not fully participate?

Q36. What was the role of Bankim Chandra Chattopadhyay in building Indian nationalism? How was Vande Mataram used as a nationalist symbol?

Q37. Explain how the idea of 'Swaraj' was understood differently by peasants, plantation workers, and tribal communities.

Q38. What were the causes of the Second Round Table Conference failing? How did it impact the nationalist movement?

Q39. Explain the circumstances that led to the Chauri Chaura incident. Why did Gandhiji consider it a grave setback?

Q40. How did the Non-Cooperation Movement affect relationships between different communities in India? Explain with examples.

Q41. Describe the role of Mahatma Gandhi's three local satyagrahas — Champaran, Kheda, and Ahmedabad — before the Non-Cooperation Movement.

Q42. What was the significance of 'Purna Swaraj' declared at the Lahore Congress? How was it different from earlier demands for self-rule?

Q43. Explain how the revival of Indian folklore and folk traditions helped build nationalist sentiment in India.

Q44. Describe the role of the press and literature in spreading nationalist ideas during the freedom movement.

Q45. How did the issue of separate electorates create a conflict between Gandhi and Ambedkar? What was the outcome?

SECTION C — 5 MARKS (25 Questions)

Q1. "There were a variety of cultural processes through which Indian Nationalism captured people's imagination." Explain the statement with examples. (PYQ 2024)

Q2. Analyse the ways through which people of different communities developed a sense of collective belonging in India. (PYQ 2023)

Q3. Examine the progress of the Civil Disobedience Movement among rich peasants, poor peasants, women, tribal communities, and workers. (PYQ 2023)

Q4. Explain the implications of the First World War on the economic and political situation of India in detail. (PYQ 2023, 2020)

Q5. Describe the role of poor peasantry in the Civil Disobedience Movement. (PYQ 2020)

Q6. List all the different social groups which joined the Non-Cooperation Movement of 1921. Choose any three and explain their hopes and struggles. (PYQ)

Q7. Discuss the Salt March to make clear why it was an effective symbol of resistance against colonialism. (PYQ)

Q8. How did the Non-Cooperation Movement unfold across India — in cities, towns, and the countryside? Explain with examples.

Q9. "Tribal peasants interpreted the message of Mahatma Gandhi and the idea of Swaraj in their own way." Justify this with examples from Andhra Pradesh and Gudum Hills.

Q10. Explain the factors that led Gandhiji to launch the Civil Disobedience Movement in 1930. What were its main features and how did it spread across India?

Q11. Why did Mahatma Gandhi decide to withdraw the Non-Cooperation Movement in 1922? What were the consequences of this withdrawal on the nationalist movement?

Q12. How had the First World War created a new economic and political situation in India? Explain with five examples. (*PYQ — most repeated*)

Q13. How did the Civil Disobedience Movement differ from the Non-Cooperation Movement? Compare across five points including methods, participation, and outcome.

Q14. Explain how different classes — merchants, industrialists, peasants, workers, and women — participated in the Civil Disobedience Movement. What were its limitations?

Q15. Examine the role of women in India's nationalist movement. How did their participation change from the Non-Cooperation Movement to the Civil Disobedience Movement?

Q16. How did the Rowlatt Act, the Jallianwala Bagh massacre, and the Khilafat issue together contribute to the launch and spread of the Non-Cooperation Movement?

Q17. Describe the events and significance of the Dandi March. Why is it considered a turning point in India's freedom struggle?

Q18. Why did political leaders differ sharply over the question of separate electorates? Explain the views of Gandhi and Ambedkar and describe the Poona Pact.

Q19. "Swaraj meant different things to different people." Justify this statement by explaining how peasants, tribal communities, plantation workers, and women understood Swaraj differently.

Q20. How was the sense of collective belonging created among Indians during the nationalist movement? Explain the role of symbols, songs, folklore, icons, and imagery with five examples.

Q21. Explain the causes and consequences of the Jallianwala Bagh massacre. How did it change the nature and intensity of the nationalist movement in India?

Q22. Describe the main events of the Civil Disobedience Movement from 1930 to 1934. Why was it ultimately called off? What did it achieve?

Q23. "The Non-Cooperation Movement was the first true mass movement in India's freedom struggle." Justify this statement with five supporting points covering different sections of society.

Q24. How did the Indian National Congress evolve from a limited elite organisation to a mass-based national movement through the 1920s and 1930s? Trace the role of Gandhiji.

Q25. Explain the three local satyagrahas launched by Gandhiji — Champaran (1917), Kheda (1917), and Ahmedabad (1918). How did they prepare the ground for the Non-Cooperation Movement?